

IN PRACTICE

What to keep when you clear

Keep the worn

The chair with the softened arm, the bowl with the chip you remember happening. Wear is *wabi* — proof of a life. Minimalism throws it out; kanso keeps it and lets it show.

Cut the spare

The third near-identical vase, the cushion bought to fill, the gadget used twice. Not because you must own little — because these mean nothing, and meaning is the only rule.

Leave the gap

When you've cleared, resist refilling. The empty stretch of shelf is *ma* — the interval — and it is the thing that makes everything beside it legible.

